

# JACK SENECHAL

## ENGINEERING MANAGER

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Located in Novato, CA

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## SUMMARY

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Engineering manager with **6+ years leading teams that own production services**, and hands-on with the systems those teams run.

- **Production ownership:** led the teams responsible for a SaaS platform's infrastructure and its integration platform; **~100x reduction in error rates**, zero-downtime migrations of stateful services to Kubernetes, and an on-call culture that cut incidents while retaining the people on the rotation.
- **Team building:** rebuilt a DevOps team from two engineers after mass departures, recruited and grew multiple pods, and **grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles**. The on-call rotation, runbooks, and hiring loop outlived my tenure.
- **AI-native delivery:** operates agent-driven "software factories," applying the same planning, review, and CI-gate discipline to agent teams that makes human teams work. Daily power user of coding agents.
- **Planning across horizons:** owned roadmap stewardship and requirements triage for a platform team while staying close enough to the code to evaluate design tradeoffs myself.
- **Remote and async by habit:** writing-first, durable records over verbal handoff, distributed teams since 2014.

## INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

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### Independent Consultant · AI-Native Software Delivery

Client engagements | May 2026 - Present | Remote

- **Running "software factories":** agent-driven delivery pipelines that carry engineering work from spec to shipped, with the human in the product seat.
- **Core thesis:** the same DevOps and project-management discipline that makes human teams work is also the necessary and sufficient foundation for agent teams, encoded into the harness and context.
- **GitHub as the coordination substrate:** issues, PRs, and Projects are the single ledger.
- **Harness-enforced SDLC:** PRs gated by independent fresh-context reviewer, green CI, supply-chain scanning, deployment smoke check.
- **Self-improving harness:** Orchestration agents tasked with running, observing, and refining the process. Agents collaboratively converge on refinements, ship and evaluate.
- **Human in the product role:** defining and prioritizing work, verifying against deployed previews, steering product and process.

### Co-founder & Fractional CTO

Building Humane Technology | June 2025 - Present | Remote (part-time)

- **Originated and co-architected HumaneBench.ai**, an open-source AI evaluation framework built on AISI Inspect. **Python**.
- Acting as **fractional CTO to the team** that built it out to a published, externally usable product, shaping architecture, scoring design, and multi-provider support, and guiding documentation and positioning.
- Extending the framework toward **real-time evaluation**: built a **low-latency proof-of-concept classifier** that scores model behavior against HumaneBench rubrics inline at **sub-100ms** and can sit in a production request path rather than run only in batch.
- Designing **telemetry for operational visibility**, and evaluation feedback loops to inform system-prompt iteration and model fine-tuning.
- Owning **technical product direction and roadmap**: production monitoring, multi-turn evaluation, and adoption maturity models.

### Co-founder & Software Engineer

Alchemy Astrology (formerly Mirror Astrology) | Nov 2024 - Jul 2026 | Remote

- Owned front-end development: Ruby on Rails views, JavaScript, HTML+CSS, Tailwind, responsive UI/UX.
- Led design and UX delivery, working with freelance designers and translating their designs into the Rails framework.
- Collaborated on back-end development: Stripe integration, SSO authentication, Rails MVC.
- Collaborated closely with co-founders on product direction, Figma design, UX, roadmap planning, and prioritization.

### Infrastructure Engineer

Tobiko | Mar 2024 - Oct 2024 | Remote

- Architected and implemented a scalable cloud platform serving customer workloads at a fast-paced startup.
- Built CI/CD patterns including mono-repo conditional workflows, workload identity federation, and continuous delivery.
- Implemented a Slack-based customer support and incident response platform; onboarded teammates and customers.
- Python, Pulumi, GCP, GKE, Cloud Run, CircleCI, Helm, SQLMesh.

### Engineering Manager / Principal Software Engineer

Mavenlink / Kantata | Apr 2017 - Dec 2023 | San Francisco, CA

- **M-Bridge Integration Platform** (2 years): Led a team to stabilize and scale an agent-based integration platform handling multi-system data orchestration. Established operational metrics and monitoring that reduced errors and incidents by ~100x. Executed a zero-downtime migration to Kubernetes including relational, document, and cache databases.
- **Infrastructure Platform** (4 years): Took over a DevOps team reduced to two engineers by departures and rebuilt it from near-zero: hiring, onboarding, documentation, and on-call practice. Led the organization's DevOps culture transformation as change agent and technical authority across engineering. Owned roadmap stewardship, requirements triage, and priority management while staying hands-on with architecture and code review. Migrated the Rails monolith and its surrounding services to Kubernetes, and moved a segfaulting MySQL tier to RDS, eliminating that class of incident. Transitioned the platform to Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Ansible, Kubernetes).
- **On-call and reliability**: Ran a sustained reliability push across the DevOps org that dramatically reduced on-call incidents and error rates, with strong retention on the rotation and good developer relations across engineering. Top Performer Award, 2021.
- **BI Data Pipeline** (3 months): Led a transition team to take ownership of and improve the analytics data pipeline. Migrated the pipeline to Kubernetes.
- **People**: Grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles, and mentored engineers across teams. Led interviewing and hiring. Drove organizational change management and process optimization.

### Lead Developer, Co-founder

Pegg | 2014 - 2017 | San Francisco, CA

- Designed, architected, and built a cross-platform mobile app from scratch (iOS/Android). Node.js backend, JS/Phonegap frontend, Firebase real-time systems, CI/CD to AWS/CloudFront via CircleCI.
- Established engineering workflow: pair programming, automated testing (Karma/Chai), continuous integration, and rapid deployment processes.
- Co-led product strategy, monetization, and launch planning.

### Earlier Career (2001 - 2014)

- **Consultant & Entrepreneur** (2008 - 2014): Founded OpenTest Pro (automated testing education). Built e-commerce ordering system for Turnbull & Asser shirtmakers. Full-stack consulting in Ruby on Rails, Node.js, D3 data visualization. Rapid prototyping and client delivery.
- **Web Developer, OnForce, Inc** (2006 - 2007): Introduced automated testing and CI. Built comprehensive API test suite. Integrated platform with Salesforce APIs.
- **Development Lead, JBA Network** (2003 - 2006): Lead programmer and project manager for mynewsletterbuilder.com. Architected the initial release, then built and scaled the development team.

## OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

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### Scan MCP (2024 - Present)

MCP (Model Context Protocol) server for scanner automation and document digitization. Privacy-first architecture with smart device discovery, JSON Schema validation, and support for both local stdio and network HTTP transports. TypeScript/Node.js.

[github.com/jacksenechal/scan-mcp](https://github.com/jacksenechal/scan-mcp)

### HumaneBench (2024 - Present)

Evaluation framework for measuring human-friendly behavior in AI assistants, built on AISI Inspect. Tests AI responses across humane technology principles including loneliness, mental health, transparency, and privacy. Supports multiple LLM providers with extensible scenario datasets. Python.

[github.com/buildinghumanetech/humanebench](https://github.com/buildinghumanetech/humanebench)

## SKILLS

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- **Languages & Frameworks:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Ruby on Rails, Node.js, Bash.
- **Front-end:** React, Vue, HTML, CSS, Tailwind, Responsive Design, UI/UX.
- **Back-end & Data:** API Design, Microservices, Distributed Systems, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis.
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Pulumi, Helm.
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** CircleCI, GitHub Actions, Automated Testing, TDD, Infrastructure as Code, Cloud-Native Architecture, On-call Design, Incident Response, Observability.
- **AI/LLM:** MCP (Model Context Protocol), chatbot development, prompt engineering, tool use, context augmentation.
- **Leadership:** Team Building, Coaching & Mentoring, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Roadmap Ownership, Hiring, Agile/Scrum/Kanban, Change Management.

## EDUCATION

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### BA in Mathematics, minor in Computer Science

University of North Carolina at Asheville | May 2003

- Graduated with distinction in Mathematics. Undergraduate research in 4D fractals.

## RECOMMENDATIONS

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“Jack is **an exceptional engineer and leader**. He strives to **deeply understand the technology** he’s working on while remaining cognizant of the socio-technical components that may be a factor in any project. He’s thorough, detail-oriented, and outcome-oriented, which means **the solutions he architects, builds, and collaborates on come out better**. Jack also strives to be at the forefront of new technology and assess how he can leverage it. He does all this with a **strong team mentality**, is a phenomenal team player, and can **effectively delegate to help lift others’ skill sets**.”

— *Brandon Clifford, Director of DevOps, Kantata*

“Jack has **had quite a profound impact on my career**. As a young engineer, I was fortunate enough to work with Jack as my coach. He served as a great mentor, helping me build both technical and professional skills and **forming me into the engineer that I am today**. **His mentorship was a key factor in elevating me from an incoming Junior Engineer to an Engineering Manager**. Jack has a great curiosity and a strong set of technical capabilities that allow him to serve as a great example for others and a key contributor to any team!”

— *Wesley Morlock, Engineering Manager, Kantata*

“Jack is a fantastic engineer always ready to **help solve problems and more importantly, teach you how to solve them**. He guided me and my team through a bunch of challenging GitOps situations with patience and kindness, leading by example. Always diligent with his work, willing to roll up his sleeves to get things done and **find creative solutions**. Everyone would be lucky to have someone like him in their teams!”

— *Cesar Palafox Garza, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata*

“Jack is **awesome at understanding the direction teams need to go to make important improvements in Kantata’s Engineering organization as a whole**. He has been instrumental in building and implementing strategies to upgrade Ruby, Rails, and React. If I had any questions about infrastructure and Kubernetes he would be able to answer and **provide solid explanations to the entire team**.”

— *Justin Hurstwright, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata*

See additional recommendations on LinkedIn